Case Study: Phishing Scam

Phishing is one of the most common types of cybercrime where attackers try to trick people into sharing sensitive information like passwords, OTPs, or bank details. These scams usually happen through fake emails, messages, or websites that look genuine.

A typical example can be seen when a student receives an email that appears to be from their bank or a popular platform like a shopping site. The message may say that their account has been blocked or that urgent action is required. It includes a link that looks real, but actually leads to a fake website.

When the student clicks the link and enters their login details, the information is directly captured by the attacker. In some cases, users may also be asked to enter OTPs, which allows scammers to access their bank accounts.

Students are often targeted because they may not carefully check the authenticity of emails or links. The consequences of phishing include loss of money, hacked accounts, and misuse of personal data.

This case highlights the importance of being alert while checking emails and messages. Even if something looks genuine, it is always better to verify before taking action.

Reflection

While researching phishing attacks, what surprised me the most was how realistic fake messages and websites can look. It is very easy for anyone, especially students, to mistake them for genuine communication from banks or trusted services. I also realized that most cybercrimes succeed not because of technical hacking, but due to human error and lack of awareness. One habit I will personally change is being more cautious before clicking on any link or entering sensitive information online. I will always verify the source and double-check URLs. Additionally, I will make sure to never share OTPs or UPI PINs with anyone, no matter how urgent the request seems. This awareness will help me stay safer online.